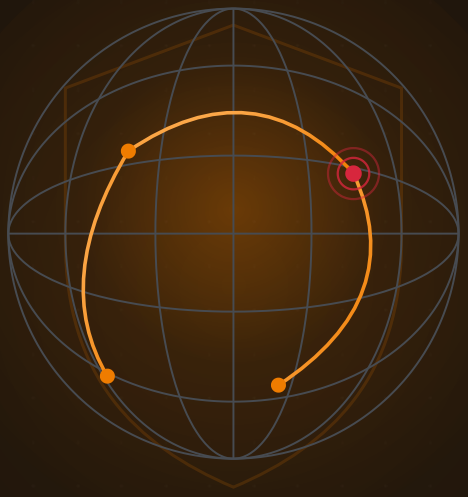
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EDITION 13
19 OCTOBER 2026



THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 12 – 18 OCTOBER 2026

A VPN zero-day under attack at Ivanti — plus a China-linked hit on BeyondTrust remote-support tools, an exploited Cisco email-gateway flaw, and Microsoft's record October update.

Prepared by DPG-Cyber
Client threat intelligence

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves worldwide. This week's standout story is a zero-day flaw in **Ivanti Connect Secure**, a popular business VPN that attackers were using for about ten days before a fix existed. We also cover **BeyondTrust** remote-support software, a **Cisco** email-security appliance and **Microsoft's record October update**. No jargon, just practical steps.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

8.6 /10
Severity of this week's Ivanti VPN flaw (high)

5,500+
Ivanti VPN gateways visible on the internet

~10 days
Attacked before a fix was released

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

IVANTI CONNECT SECURE · CVE-2026-104935

Business VPN zero-day lets attackers take over Ivanti gateways — no password needed

8.6 /10 CVSS
HIGH

Exploitation: **confirmed in real attacks (on US CISA's exploited list)**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

On **13 October 2026** Ivanti fixed a flaw (**CVE-2026-104935**, rated **8.6 out of 10**) in **Ivanti Connect Secure**, the VPN many firms use to let staff work remotely. It lets an attacker who has **no username or password** run commands on the gateway. Security firm Volexity found a previously unknown group using it, chained with other flaws, to gain **full control** from at least **3 October** — even on up-to-date devices. The attackers installed no obvious malware and covered their tracks, and were stealing network passwords to prepare for spreading further.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Any organisation running **Ivanti Connect Secure** (22.8 and 25.1 versions): more than **5,500** are visible online. Ivanti says a limited number of customers were hit. One further weakness used in the attacks is **still waiting for a fix**, and Ivanti's built-in checking tool did not spot this attack.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

A VPN is the **front door to your office network**. Once an attacker controls it, they can harvest staff and administrator passwords and move on to your servers and data — often silently. Because the attack leaves few traces, patching alone is not enough: have your IT team **check whether the gateway was already compromised**.

Good news: patches for the main flaw are available now, and Ivanti's older 22.7 versions are not affected. Patching quickly and checking for signs of a break-in greatly reduces your risk — and if you do not use Ivanti VPN, you need do nothing.

What to do about the headline threat

- **Ask IT to update Ivanti Connect Secure today** and tell you which version each gateway now runs.
- **Ask for a compromise check,** not just a patch — the attackers hid their tracks, so IT should review logs and Ivanti's recovery guidance.
- **If a break-in is suspected,** change passwords for any accounts the VPN could reach, especially administrator accounts.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT

CRITICAL

BeyondTrust remote-support software was hacked for weeks before a fix

A flaw in **BeyondTrust Remote Support** (**CVE-2026-102764**, rated **9.3 out of 10**) let outsiders carry out file actions on the server **without logging in**. Google's threat team says a suspected **China-linked espionage group** used it as a zero-day from late August. BeyondTrust patched its cloud service on 8–9 October; customers who run the software themselves must **install the fix manually**.

Takeaway: if your IT provider uses BeyondTrust, ask that it is updated and checked for signs of tampering.

HIGH

Cisco email-security appliances are being attacked through a booby-trapped attachment

Cisco warned that a flaw in its **Secure Email Gateway** (**CVE-2026-76519**) is being exploited. A specially crafted email attachment can let an attacker write files and run commands as the **all-powerful "root" user**. It affects devices with the malware-scanning "File Reputation" feature switched on; Cisco has fixed its cloud versions and released a software update.

Takeaway: if you run your own Cisco email gateway, install Cisco's update now and ask IT to check it for signs of compromise.

MEDIUM

Microsoft's October update is its biggest ever — and includes one attacked flaw

On 13 October Microsoft released more than **1,400 fixes**, a record. One Windows flaw (**CVE-2026-96951**) is **already being exploited**; it can switch off the warning Windows normally shows on files downloaded from the internet. Two more flaws were publicly known before the fix. About 70 fixes are rated critical.

Takeaway: let Windows install October's updates this week, and restart computers so they take effect.

Your 3-minute checklist this week

- [ ] Ask IT whether you use **Ivanti Connect Secure** VPN — if so, patch it and check it for compromise today.
- [ ] Ask whether your IT provider uses **BeyondTrust** remote support or you run a **Cisco email gateway**, and that both are updated.
- [ ] Install **October's Windows updates** and restart your computers.
- [ ] Ask for a list of every **remote-access tool and VPN** your business exposes to the internet — and who monitors each.
- [ ] Check that every remote login (VPN, support tools) needs **more than a password**, and that you use a **password manager** so no password is reused.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 19 October 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a watchful eye changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion	Foothold	Lateral movement	Impact
the way in	quietly settling in	spreading across systems	data theft / ransomware

The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES

Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.

Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.

Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the VPN and remote-access attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.

Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Update your Ivanti VPN — and check it

If you use Ivanti Connect Secure, ask IT to install the fixed version (**22.8R2.5, 25.1.1.2 or 25.1.3.x**, depending on your model) today, then **check for signs of a break-in** and reset any passwords the VPN could reach.

GOOD HABIT

Use a password manager

A password manager gives every account its **own long, unique password** — so when attackers steal one from a hacked system, as in this week's VPN attacks, it cannot unlock everything else.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at **hello@dpg-cyber.com**.